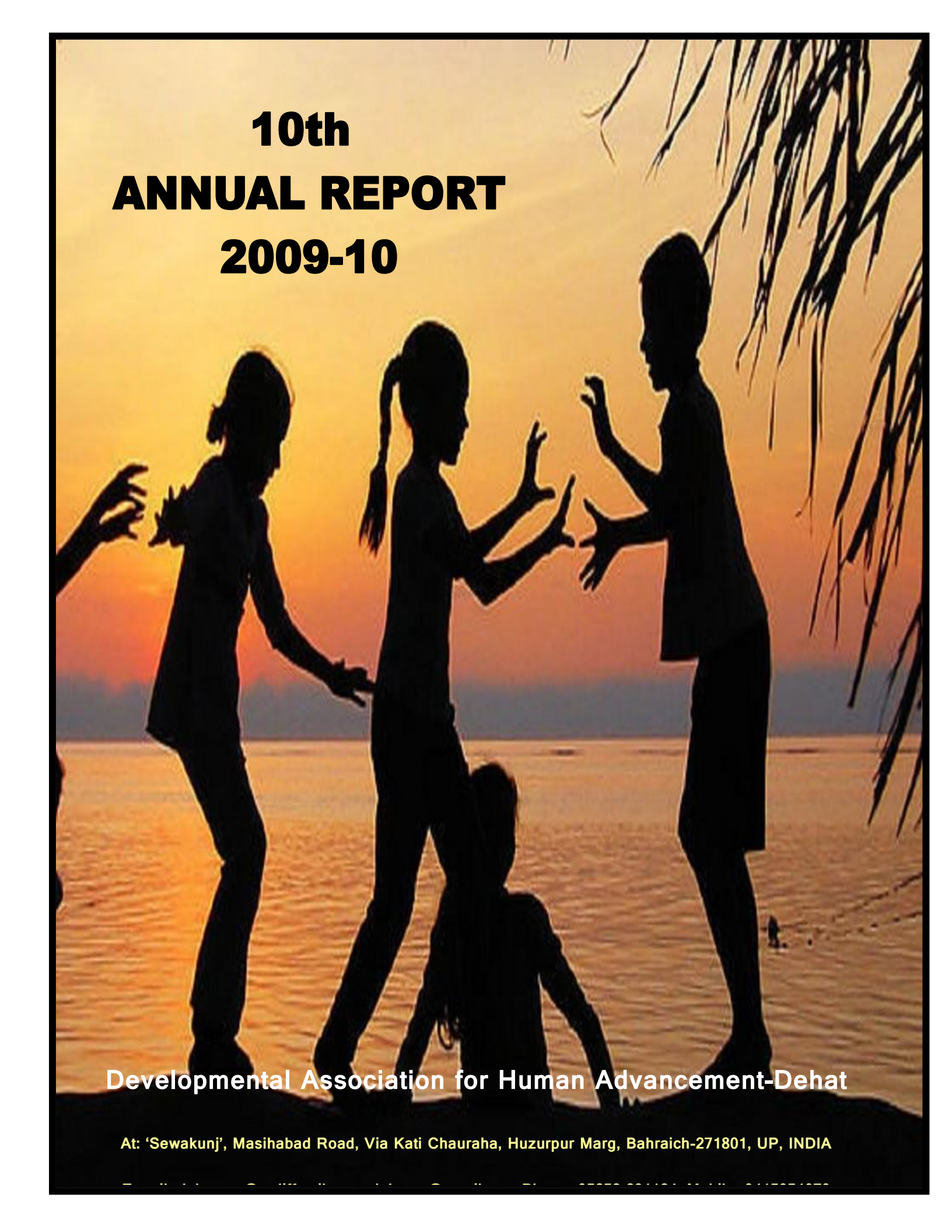


The background of the entire page is a photograph showing the silhouettes of three children playing on a beach. The children are in the foreground, their dark shapes contrasting against the bright, orange and yellow sky of a sunset. The child on the left is reaching out, the middle child is standing with arms slightly out, and the child on the right is also reaching out. The ocean is visible in the background, and some palm fronds hang down from the top right corner.

10th ANNUAL REPORT 2009-10

Developmental Association for Human Advancement-Dehat

At: 'Sewakunj', Masihabad Road, Via Kati Chauraha, Huzurpur Marg, Bahraich-271801, UP, INDIA

Forward

I am pleased and honored on the occasion of publishing the 10th Annual Report 2009-10 of our organization Developmental Association for Human Advancement-‘DEHAT’.

When we came into being, we were entirely unaware from the word NGO, but we had a motto to transform the picture of under privileged and deprived people into an improved and sagacious society.

We were motivated for social work after seeing the badly harassed residents of Forest Villages of Bahraich, U.P. As the proofs reveal, they were accommodated by the Forest Department for the purpose of labour work in the interest of the department as ‘Begari’. They were allowed to live on forest land and grow the food-grains for survival, but they were deprived of having right to construct a concrete house and sale or purchase of their land. Their children were specially affected from the situation. Contrary to all the basic rights offered by the Constitution of Sovereign India, they were not even allowed to live like a human being and enjoy the facilities available in the environment. They were being treated as fourth grade citizen in their own land. Majority of the children were in capture of malnutrition and out-of school. The villagers could not apply for any Government job because they were not from Revenue village.

We started our work since far before inception of association. In beginning some enthusiastic youth from these undeveloped areas were united and we formed a group for social change and intensive awareness movement about the rights to these forest villagers. After that ‘Dehat’ has risen due to its honest policy of working with full of positive attitude.

‘Dehat’ has proven its significance for development of beneficiaries in target areas during 2009-10. Our organization made sincere efforts to revolve the situation towards the right direction with full of our experiences, technical ability and hard work. Our smooth functioning is reflecting a good result, because we decide the yearly plan of action of the activities in beginning of every financial year. Our staffs are technically sound and capable to deliver their knowledge to motivate target groups cleanly. Our organization was formed core committee for deciding working strategy and implementation of work plan in project areas. This committee contains of project incharges and second level staffs of each project. This core committee decides plan of action per month in a meeting on every first day of the month. This is our transparency of work among our staffs and clear-cut instructions for prioritize the issues.

The regular monitoring of our work is strengthening the project work in the field. I am keenly observing all the activities for betterment of our work to reach our Vision. During the year we have got opportunity to get partnerships with three prestigious donors for our three dream projects i.e. Empowering Rural Women Project (ERW) at Mihinpurwa Block sponsored by SDTT, IIMPACT-DEHAT Rural Girl Child Education Project at Jamunaha, Shravasti & Uttar Pradesh Participatory Forest Management and Poverty Alleviation Project in Sonebhadra District with the support of Govt. of Uttar Pradesh and Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA).

First time, we are recognized to hold the responsibilities as a **Nodal Support Organization** for a very prestigious project of Japan International Cooperation Agency-JICA and Govt. Of Uttar Pradesh. We have 4 partner NGOs in this initiative to provide hand holding support.

I congratulate my all staffs to achieve a milestone in 2009-10 through their full efforts, dedication and sincerity about their jobs. I also thank to the partner community and individuals and all stake holders including funding agency to support us in favoring in implementing the projects in the area.

Yours truly,

Dr. Jitendra Chaturvedi,
Chief Executive

Acknowledgements

We sincerely acknowledge the support provided by the agencies and our honorable community. Our all the efforts made during the Action Year-2009-10 were made possible only due to the financial support provided by the following donors:

- Child Rights & You-CRY, New Delhi.
- BAIF Development Research Foundation-Pune.
- Project for Appropriate Technology to Health-PATH International.
- Japan International Cooperation Agency-JICA
- Sir Dorabji Tata Trust- Mumbai.
- IIMPACT- Gurgawan (Haryana).
- KABIR, New Delhi
- National Bank of Agriculture and Rural Development-NABARD, Mumbai.
- Agriculture Finance Corporation- Mumbai.
- Prime Net, Lucknow.
- Uttar Pradesh Voluntary Action Network-UPVAN, Lucknow.

We devote our sincere thanks to the following associations and networks for their guidance and support in our grass root level efforts:

- United Nations Civil Society Organization's Network (CSO Net)
- White Ribbon Alliance-USA
- Asian Human Right Commission-AHRC, Hong Kong
- United Nations Millennium Campaign-UNMC
- Wada Na Todo Abhiyan-WNTA
- Parivartan, New Delhi
- Human Right Law Network-HRLN, New Delhi
- Supporting Association for Thematic & Holistic Initiatives-SATHI, Uttar Pradesh
- Uttar Pradesh Voluntary Action Network, Lucknow
- Quality Institutional Care & Alternative for Children-QIC&AC, Uttar Pradesh

To advocate the grass root level issues related to the deprived sections, the media has given tremendous response and support to our efforts. We are thankful to :

Print Media

- Indian Express, Lucknow
- Hindustan Times, Lucknow
- Dainik Jagran, Lucknow
- Amar Ujala, Lucknow
- Rashtriya Sahara, Lucknow

Electronic Media

- DD News
- All India Radio- National and FM Channel
- ETV News Channel
- Sahara Samay News Channel
- Star News

We are thankful to the all the Govt. officials who have given ever support to do our best for the betterment of the marginalized sections of the society.

Our acknowledgement will not be completed without thanking our staff & their family members, volunteers and community leaders.

The Introduction

1.1 Genesis-

Developmental Association for human advancement (DEHAT) was first established at the behest of some young people from Bahraich district in Uttar Pradesh. Bahraich has been identified amongst 100 most backward districts of India by the Planning Commission.

Dehat first started out as a school for 'Tharu' tribals and forest children. Ten years later, on 21st Aug'2000 it was registered under Society Registration Act 1860.

We firmly believe that no society can hope for sustainable development unless its children are assured of their survival, protection and participation in the development process.

In 1990, the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (CRC) came into effect establishing a comprehensive set of rights for all children. We realize that this cannot be translated into reality in absence of focused intervention on capacity development linking child rights policy and practice.

Thus, Children remain the nucleus of all our work through which we aim at human advancement. A child is affected first and foremost by his immediate family and neighborhood situation. With this view, today Dehat is involved in a multitude of community organization and development activities besides advocacy, awareness and rights struggle. Our intervention at policy making and/or influencing government is driven in the interests of the children particularly those coming from marginalized and oppressed sections of the society.

1.2 Philosophy

Thought of Dehat is to sustain the development, after any of our implementation, can ensure the mobilization of the targeted population to take active part in their own development.

Dehat seems children are future generation of our society. Generally children have certain common moral status & thoughts. We can't deny their personality as they are human beings. Since children are more sensible and curious to learn than adult, so we can bend their mind for the good one. In adult age most of the people loss their zeal. In our society people believe that a child can perform selected work only, whether an adult have all rights to do anything. Even a child have not right to involve in their own matters decided by their parents/ guardians. What makes children a special case for philosophical consideration is the combination of there humanity and the youth or more exactly there are our next generation of the society, if we ensure the child rights which are needed for the sound development of a civilized human being of children, we can fulfill the dream of a sustained and developed society.

1.3 Vision and Mission

In India about 40% of population is of children. Dehat feel that if rights of children has been missed, we can't be success in fulfill the social need. Because a child is would be citizen and the impression in childhood reflects in future.

Vision

To build a child centered society in which all children enjoy their rights and lead fulfilling lives.

Mission

To empower the deprived and under privileged sections of the society to ensure basic rights of the children.

Approach

'Dehat' has always used the motto of 'to empower deprived people to be what they want to be and do what they want to do for realizing their rights. Therefore, 'Dehat' adopted its attention

on this thought from the beginning to develop self consciousness and leadership quality in the target communities. 'Dehat' has adopted 'Right based approach' in implementing all the activities at grass root level. We never lead but aware and promote people's leadership to solve their problems.

The Geographical Coverage

'Dehat' is intervening as under:

State : Uttar Pradesh

Districts	Blocks	Villages/Hamlets	Gram Panchayats
Bahraich	Mihinpurwa	062	10
	Chittaura	198	37
	Payagpur	135	27
	Fakharpur	013	01
Shrawasti	Jamunaha	142	30
Sonbhadra	Duddhi	078	18
	Myorepur	082	20
	Babhani	063	16
TOTAL	08	773	159

Key Strategies of the year

'Dehat' is already strengthening the community organizations of the poorest families at community, hamlet, village, Gram Panchayat and block level in the adopted areas. 'Dehat' provided its technical support to control the local issues as per project requirement through regular meetings, trainings and exposures to undertake all the developmental activities at their own with ensuring social justice and equity.

Dehat also organize training, exposure and sensitization efforts for the elected members of Panchayats and Gram Sabha to strengthen the rural self-governance system.

'Dehat' initiated the learning centres, where more than 1000 Girls child, who never attended schools are covered. 'Dehat' also rendered their work for forest management & poverty alleviation programme in U.P.

Consequently, we intend to offer these efforts to the people only up to the time when they are empowered enough to leverage all these facilities at their own. There after we see our role only as an educator and facilitator.

‘Dehat’ Action Year : 2009 – 2010

‘Dehat’ design its projects by keeping the children in focus. During the action year-2009-10, the projects were as follows:

S. No.	Project Title	Funding Agency	Covered District	Covered Blocks	Covered Gram Panchayats
1	Child Right Project-Azaadi	Child Rights & You, New Delhi	Bahraich	Mihinpurwa	8 (Forest Villages)
2	Sure Start Project	PATH International and BAIF-Pune	Bahraich	Chittaura & Payagpur	59
3	Lok Nidhi	NABARD-Lucknow	Bahraich	Chittaura & Payagpur	59
4	Village Development Plan	NABARD- Lucknow	Bahraich	Fakhar Pur	01
5	Rural Girl Child Education Project	IIMPACT, Gurgaon	Shravasti	Jamunaha	18
6	Nodal Support Organization (NSO) for U. P. Participatory Forest Management & Poverty Alleviation Project.	Govt. of U.P. & JICA (Japan International Cooperation Agency)	Sonbhadra	Dudhhi, Babhani and Myorepur	56
7	ERW (Empowering Rural Women)	Sir Dorabji Tata Trust, Mumbai	Bahraich	Mihinpurva Block	10
8	Action Research on Right To Information	KABIR, New Delhi	Bahraich	10 Blocks	-
9	Right To Information Campaign	UPVAN, Lucknow	Bahraich	5 Blocks	5
10	District Perspective Planning for Effective Implementation of MNREGA in Basti district of UP	Agriculture Finance Corporation, Mumbai	Basti	5 Blocks	332
11	District Perspective Planning for Effective Implementation of MNREGA in Bahraich district of UP	Prime Net, Lucknow	Bahraich	14 Blocks	903

RURAL GIRL CHILD EDUCATION PROJECT

(A Project for Educating Non-school going and Drop-out Girl Child supported by the IIMPACT, Gurgaon, (Haryana)

Shrawasti district of Uttar Pradesh is a most backward district identified the lowest in female literacy in the country. Hence, DEHAT has initiated in the sector of "Girl Child Education" by adopting 30 villages in the lowest female literacy block of the district named: Jamunaha, situated at Indo Nepal border area.



The area is very backward and mostly Scheduled Caste & Muslim minority community are residing. They never bothered to send their girl child to school for education. The girl child were engaged in Animal feeding, Domestic work and mud work etc. many girl child are sent for job work at Brick industries, rice mills etc. as a laborer. Most of the girls are being married in their 8 to 12 years age. The child marriage is major obstacle to give emphasis for girl child education.

'Dehat' has implemented an educational project in March 2010 for non-going & dropped out Girls child of Jamunaha Block of Shrawasti district in U.P. from March 2010. The project is funded by IIMPACT organization. IIMPACT is a well honoured organization which formed by 1986 Alumni of IIM, Ahmedabad. The project was designed by this organization for improvement of education in girl children, which is very poor in the country till now.

The Main Objectives

1. To provide free of cost quality education from 1st to 5th class to the Girl Children of the age group of 6-14 Years.
2. To sensitize and make community responsible towards the education and especially of girl child.
1. To facilitate the community for demand generation for Middle Schools under the provisions of Right To Education Act-2009 and community led advocacy processes.

The Key Strategies

- Community Organization.
- Local Women Education Workers.
- Ensured community participation.
- Promotion of community practices of demanding their rights.



The Main Activities

1. Selection of never-gone and drop-out girls.
2. Identification of the place for centers by community.
3. Operation of 30 Girl Child Education Centers.
4. Free books and teaching learning materials to all the girls.

'Dehat' is committed to secure the 'right to education' for girl child who never been focused either by the society or by government. We found the education on rural level is very much formal due to poor implementation of education system in U.P. So, Dehat launched the project Rural Girl Child Education Project at Jamunaha Block of Shravasti District in U.P. Our organization conducted a survey on village for finding non-going or drop out girl child age group 6 to 14 years. We selected the lowest rate of female literacy block of India (about 10%) i.e. Jamunaha, Distt.- Shravasti (U.P.). In initial phase we selected 30 most backward villages. There are thirty centers were inaugurated in first phase of the implementation in March 2010.



These 30 learning centres are serving 1064 Girl child of age group 6 to 14 years. These centers are mainly situated at remote villages of the Jamunaha block of Shravasti district of U.P. state. The places for centres are provided by village community whereas the learning material i.e. Copy, Pencil, Books & stationeries are provided by the project. Talented, trained and dedicated part time female teachers from nearby villages for every center are provided by the project.

'Dehat' has formed initially 8 to 12 members committee in every village, where centres are running. This committee is keeping all the matter for uninterrupted operation of centres daily. They made to authorize to check all activities and facilities at centres under this project. Supervisors are visiting to the centres for surety of success of the centres. The Project Coordinator is responsible for continuity and quality education of the centre.

EMPOWERING RURAL WOMEN –ERW PROJECT

(A Project for Empowerment of rural women supported by Sir Dorabjee Tata Trust, Mumbai)

'Dehat' has initiated a new project entitled : Empowering Rural Women in February 2010. Mihinpurwa Block of Bahraich District supported by Sir Dorabjee Tata Trust, Mumbai. The covered block is most backward and also situated in forest area. The schemes of Govt. have not been implemented clearly in the block so far. The project is based on systematic approach for empowerment of rural women to aware them for their rights to increase their livelihood. 'Dehat' is working here under this project for most deprived and underserved women to capacitate/ aware them for their rights to get benefit of various Government schemes like MNREGA, PDS schemes etc.

'Dehat' has always believes in empowering women those are having closer relation with their children.

The following activities were organized during the month of February and March-2010:



- One representative was selected preferably from SC, ST and Muslim communities as Community Level Workers and trained on MNREGA, Right To Work, Right To Food, Right To Information, local self governance and Govt. development schemes.



- The baseline survey was conducted in 10 Gram Panchayats.
- Open meetings with community were organized in 10 Gram Panchayats and addressed 2344 persons.
- Women Organizations were initiated in 6 Gram Panchayats.

- On 8th March-2010, a Women Empowerment Camp was organized in Badkhadia Bazar of Mihinpurwa block of Bahraich district (UP). About 3000 women from 10 intervention gram panchayats have participated in the programme. Mrs. Urmila Sartaz- Area Organizer, Sashastra Seema Bal was the Chief Guest and Mr. Shashi Bhushan of PANI-Faizabad was the Guest of Honor. In the meet the women have strongly raised their voices on domestic violence, gender discrimination, illiteracy among women, poor education status of girl children and poor work opportunity in MNREGA.



SURE START PROJECT

(A project for Maternal and Neo-natal Health Care)

In the mid of the year 2007, Developmental Association for Human Advancement- DEHAT had implemented Sure Start Project with support of Bill and Millinda Gets foundation, PATH International USA and BAIF Pune, with aim to reduce maternal and Neonatal death, along with behavior change of community on maternal and neonatal health in two blocks of Baharaich district namely Chittaura and Payagpur.

For the implementation of the project two target group were identified and reconstituted – one was Village Health and Sanitation Committee (VHSC) to which we take as user group for community based planning, implementation and evaluation process. This group also worked as a link for advocacy on maternal and neonatal health issue between community and block level committee. Our second group to which we call mother group (MG) include pregnant and lactating women and their female in-laws (Its member change periodically) with this group we used to talk about 5 key issues/messages of Sure Start project which are as under:-



1. Evaluation of MNH related behavior and orientation about Sure Start project.
2. New born care (Thermal and Cord care)
3. Birth preparedness.
4. Immediate and exclusive breast feeding.
5. Danger sign recognition in mother and neonate.

Other than the above two group we give more emphasis over male participation by organizing open meeting with them in this we discuss about, our so far progress on maternal and neonatal health and problem we are facing at community and block level. Secondly we make home visit with ASHA/AWW to encourage those women who are not participating in mother group meeting.

Case Study

LETTER OF PAPA INDICATED DANGER OF BIRTH A LIFE

I Gudiya W/o Peshkar residing in Diha Gram Panchayat in Chittaura Block of Bahraich. I was pregnant and I was very weak, perhaps I had deficiency of blood means I was anemic. I got often hard pain during my pregnancy. My family was not aware of safety during pregnancy. One person from DEHAT under Sure Start project were visited to my home and met my Father in law and gave him a "Letter of Father" published under the project. After 20 days I got severe pain and taken a medicine and discharged some blood after that. My Father in Law contacted with the person of DEHAT, because person of Dehat had given its mobile number to my father in law. So, he contacted with Dehat team member, when he came I was discharging blood. He understood it is the symbol of lack of precaution, so he guided Asha Bahu to take me at PHC. After many hours I could be saved with my safe delivery of baby. Now I am enjoying my life with my baby and family.

By 2011, there will be improved knowledge and service delivery mechanism for promoting maternal and neo-natal health and preventing maternal and neo-natal deaths from Chittaura and Payagpur blocks.

Currently we are covering **32 Gram Panchayats in Chittaura and 27 Gram Panchayats in Payagpur block of Bahraich district.** Activities which are performed during this year to meet the aim of project are as under:-

The Project Purpose

Catalyze sustainable improvement of maternal and new born status through effective community action in designated blocks of Bahraich district.

The Key Strategies

1. Strengthening of existing institutions like Village Health and Sanitation Committees [VHSCs] at Gram Panchayat level, Mother Group-MG at ICDS center level, Rogi Kalyan Samiti-RKS at block level.
2. Capacity building and networking of ASHAs, ANMs and ICDS Workers at Gram Panchayat level.
3. The main focus will be on the capacity building of the ASHAs for effective performance of her duties.

The Objectives

The basic objectives are as follows:

1. To significantly increase individual, household and community action that directly and indirectly improves maternal and new born health.
2. To enhance systems and institutional capabilities for sustained improvement in maternal and new born care and health status.

The interventions

The major four interventions are given below:

- Community Mobilization, demand generation and facilitating an enabling environment.
- House hold skill building in essential maternal and new born care and seeking.
- Facilitating access to skilled attendance at birth and essential commodities such as safe delivery kits and essential antibiotics to mange sever infections.
- Strengthening of linkages between communities and the public and private care system.

The Activities

a. Trainings and Orientations

For the sustainability of efforts, 'Dehat' believes in the investment in human resource development. We have organized various programmes for the capacity building of ASHAs (Accredited Social Health Activists), Gram Pradhans, Mother Groups and Govt. Officials.

The details are under:

- a. **ASHA orientations** were organized 3 times in both the intervention blocks in which 67 ASHAs from Payagpur and 83 ASHAs from Chittaura were participated in all the three programmes.
- b. **Orientations of Block Level officials** were conducted on quarterly basis in both the intervention blocks. During the year 3 programmes were organized in each



block. The programmes were aimed to review the progress and ensure the co-operation of each stakeholder department in the project.

- c. The role of local self governance institutions is too important in the success of any programme at grass root level. In the Sure Start project, we realize that the Village Health and Sanitation Committees (VHSCs) are an important part of the project. Hence, we have organized the 'Trainings of Pradhans on MNH issue and VHSC Functions'.

b. Campaigns

To mobilize the community and to create an environment to protect the neo-natal and mothers, 'Dehat' organizes campaigns on periodical basis. During the year, the campaigns organized in the area are as under:

<i>S. No.</i>	<i>Name of Campaign</i>	<i>Duration</i>	<i>Covered Areas</i>	<i>Participation</i>		
				<i>Male</i>	<i>Female</i>	<i>Total</i>
1	Breast Feeding Week	07.08.2008 to 13.08.2008	Chittaura and Payagpur Blocks	5321	8234	13555
2	Nutrition Week	05.09.2008 to 12.09.2008	Chittaura and Payagpur Blocks	4778	6897	11675
3	Campaign on Safe-motherhood	11.04.2008	Chittaura and Payagpur Blocks	1277	2346	3623
	Total			11376	17477	28853

d. Community Mobilization

'Dehat' use innovative methods for community mobilization. Some key methods are as under:

Participatory Wall paintings and wall writing in project village

To aware community towards the stake holders on the maternal and neo-natal health care issues, reasons for maternal and neo-natal deaths and behavior change in traditional practices, 118 wall paintings were made by using participatory methods and involving people.

Street Theatre

We have organized 164 theatre shows in the 59 intervention villages and reached to more than 80,000 population directly with the messages to save the lives of maternal and neo-natals.

Video Van Promotion

With the collaboration of IMPACT India, PATH International and BAIF, we have organized 72 video shows on maternal and new born care in both the intervention blocks. More than 35000 people were benefited.

Innovative Tools for Community Education

We use innovative community education tools named 'Thermal Care Tool', Cord Cutting Tool', and 'Birth Preparedness Tool'. In these tools we use toys, plastic passels and games based on snake and ladder game and Ludo. Community plays these tools/games in the quality facilitation of our Field Coordinators

CHILD RIGHTS PROJECT

(A Project for Ensuring the Rights of Children in the forest villages)

The Child Rights Project was started in the year 2005 in the 8 forest villages (the villages inhabited on forest lands) in *Mihinpurwa block of Bahraich district* in *Uttar Pradesh* state with the help of *CRY- Child Right and You, New Delhi*.

The children as well as the residents of these villages are not considered as Indian citizens and as result they were not considered eligible for any type of Govt. schemes, no residence and caste and income certificate was issued by any Govt. official to these forest village residents. Due to lack of residence, caste and income certificates, these villagers were not eligible for opening their bank accounts in any recognized bank and taking bank loans for self employment initiatives, applying in Govt. jobs, applying for passport etc. The children of these villages were living with a dark future. The names of the forest villages are; *Bhawanipur, Bichhia, Bichhia Bazar, Kailashnagar and Nishad Nagar (Dhakia), Nai Basti (Tedhia), Katarnia Ghat, Gokulpur (Dafadar Gaurhi) and Rampur Retia*. All these villages have a *population of 6413* lives in *1034 households*.

To ensure the rights of this right less population, following activities were organized during the year 2010-2011:-

1. RIGHTS TO DEVELOPMENT:-

The following work done under this vital issue :-

A. Apply for R.T.I. related to opening of new Anganwadi Centres & new Govt. Schools in the area:-

There are not any Anganwadis & Schools present in the area. So, five children have died due to lacking of nutritious foods/ awareness about nutrition in their food and 465 children are far away from education. Because of lacking of schools children are bounded to be a child labour. So that fifty one forest villagers have demanded information under R.T.I. about construction of new schools and setting up of Anganwadi in the area from Government.

B. Right to Education & Nutrition Rally:-

The covered eight forest villages are situated in Katarniya Forest area under Mihipurwa Block of Baharaich district. The primary schools and anganwadi centres are not present here. So that 465 children of the covered forest villages are far away from education and facing malnutrition.

Case Study

MY EDUCATION IS CONTINUING

My name is Kiran Kumari. I am 15 years old. My father's Name is Radheshyam. I live in Forest Village Nishad Nagar, Gram Panchayat Chehalwa, District Bahraich. I am from a very poor family.

I was enrolled in 3rd class in Govt. Primary School. Initially I was visited to school, but I found there is no system of study and teachers are very much irresponsible. So, after some day I leave to go school and never had been visited school. Now, I was engaged in domestic works & agricultural work for my home. I was not interested in study, so I was neglecting to go school due to my previous experience of school.

A NFE (Non Formal Education) centre was opened in my forest village by Dehat organization with support of CRY-New Delhi. But I was not agreeing to go to centre for study. Then the team of Dehat was arrived to my house and convinced me and my family for my study. They were also informed the benefit of learning. I got enrolled in NFE centre and the centre had good quality education. Now I was determined to do well and started study with heart. I felt that my mind was spreading and was receiving the lessons quickly. In one and half years I passed class five with good numbers. During the study in NFE centre I labour hard and completed all assignments given by teacher. Even I was accomplishing more than the given home work daily.

These children are bounded to be a child labour. The people of forest villages have organized "Right to Education & Nutrition Rally" on 23.06.2009 with the support of DEHAT social work organization after seeing these miserable conditions. The rally concluded at the office of District Magistrate of Bahraich and a petition for the issue had been send to Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh through Addition District Magistrate (ADM). Five hundred thirty six forest villages had been participated in the rally.

Four hundred sixty five child of the covered eight forest villages were away from education. So that DEHAT have started N.F.E, Centres on 1st July 2009 with the help of CRY, New Delhi at forest villages Nishad Nagar, Bhawanipur & Kailash Nagar. The children of these forest villages have been attached with the centres. In addition to that in July 2009 our organization has provided to include 10 children of N.F.E. centres with primary education to regularize their education.

D. The Exposure Visits organized by S.S.B. to the girls of the Forest Villages:-

The social responsibility department of S.S.B. (Seema Sashstra Bal) have organized a exposure visits from 18th Dec. to 25th Dec. 2009 to the 20 girls of the Kishori Mandal. These girls have been got the opportunity to visit the historical places of India and opportunity to meet with Home Minister, I.G., D.I.G. senior officials etc. These girls were put the issues of forest villages to these higher authorities. S.S.B. have arranged the visit to the historical/ religious places like Delhi, Agra, Kanpur, Rajasthan, Jaipur, Mathura etc. for the girls. Girls were put the problem of electricity in the area to I.G. & D.I.G. of S.S.B. Now S.S.B. has installed Solar Lights in the forest villages on 3rd March 2010. This facility will protect villagers from wild animals and situation of flood.

E. Struggle for placement of Govt. Teachers in Forest Villages:-

An awareness campaign on "Forest Right Act" has been organized on 15th July 2009 in the chairmanship of District Magistrate, Bahraich. The people of the forest villages put the problem of education of their children in front of D.M. and B.S.A. Then these officers passed the order to place two Govt. teachers in Nishad Nagar and Bhawanipur. From the next month two Govt. teachers had been placed at above forest villages and classes were started. But in August the teacher from Bhawanipur village had left the centre for three months training. Now the forest villagers have demanded from D.M. & B.S.A. for placement of other Govt. teacher for regularize the education. But it is still pending.

F. Issuance of the certificate for Handicaps:-

Fourteen handicapped children of the forest villages have been received "Handicapped Certificate" from Community Treatment Centre, Mihipurwa for Socio Economic benefits for their future. In addition to that Dehat have helped in issuance of 41 Handicapped Certificate to 41 forest villagers.

G. Attempt for Uniform, Books & Scholarship for the children of forest villages through Government Schools:-

Dehat has attempt and made success in distribution of School Uniform & books for the children of N.F.E. Centres at Bhawanipur & Nishad Nagar through Government Schools in July 2009. Even Dehat have supported in providing of scholarships to the children of Nishad Nagar in September 2009.

1. RIGHTS TO PROTECTION:-

A. Attempt to provide Land properties to the forest villagers under Forest Right Act:-

During the year, 1024 claims under Forest Rights Act were filed. In which, the only 899 claims have been passed and sent to middle level committee.

Out of these, the preparations have been completed to convert one of our intervention forest village named-Gokulpur (Dafadar Gaurhi) at district administration level.

a. Conduction of awareness campaign on “Forest Right Act” in chairmanship of District Magistrate:-

A awareness camp was organized on “Forest Right Act” in chairmanship of Mr. Subhash Chandra Sharma, District Magistrate, Bahraich on 15 July 2009 at auditorium of Sharda Sahayak Pariyojana Inter Collage-Girijapuri, Baharaich-UP. All the related departments at District level had represented the camp. D.M. had informed the forest villagers about the various rights of forest S.Cs & regular forest villagers under Forest Right Act. 2006.

b. Conduction of Meeting on “Forest Rights Act” awareness in chairmanship of Additional District Magistrate:-

A awareness meeting on “Forests Right Act.” had been organized in Auditorium of Sharda Sahayak Pariyojna College, Girijapuri on 23 Jan. 2010 in chairmanship of A.D.M, Bahraich. There were officials of district administration to Gram Panchayat Pradhan participated in the meeting. The objective of this meeting was to convert the Forest Villages to Revenue Village for availability of all facilities provided by Govt. to the peoples of these villages. There were 919 participants participated in the meeting.

c. Surprise Visit of District Magistrate, Bahraich at Forest Village Bhawanipur.

D.M., Bahraich visited to Forest Village Bhawanipur at random on dt. 7 Feb. 2010 and meet with the villagers of Bhawanipur & members of Van Adhikar Manch for negotiation on conversion of this forest village into revenue village. He gave assurance for the conversion as soon as possible to the forest villagers.

B. Attempt for awareness of Forest Villagers on Right to Information Act:-

a. One day Workshop on Right to Information:-

A one day workshop on Right to Information Act. had been organized in Auditorium of Sharda Sahayak Pariyojna College, Girijapuri on 29 Sept. 2009. Mr. Vanshidhar Boudh as a chief guest & Mr. Prakash Narayan Sinha, Principal as a special guest participated in the workshop. 650 forest villagers were participated in workshop.

b. Participation of RTI Users Forest Villagers in the National Workshop on the topic of “General people and Right to Information”:-

Ms. Bhanmati of Nai Basti & Mr. Ramvriksh of Nishad Nagar forest villages had visited New Delhi for participation in a programme on Right to Information. These volunteers of Van Adhikar Manch have shared their experiences of gained skills amongst Forest Villagers on dt. 11 Oct. 2009 for Right to Information and benefits of that.

This national workshop was jointly organized by United Nations Millennium Campaign and KABIR, New Delhi.

Mr. Wazahat Habibullah- Chief Central Information Commissioner was the chief guest.

After the workshop, both the participants were invited to give their interview in All India Radio, New Delhi.

C. Campaign for MNREGA Implementation:-

a. Visit to participate in “Jan Sunvai” Workshop at Lucknow of “VAM” Members in the leadership of DEHAT Team and meet Addl. Commissioner:-

Chief Functionary of DEHAT Dr. Jitendra Chaturvedi & Dehat volunteer Dr. Jung Hindustani lead the team of Vanadhikar Manch to visit & participate in “Jan Sunwai” workshop at Lucknow on 3rd Nov. 2009. Mr. Bhagwat, Addl. Commissioner lead 170 labors of the forest villages for job demand & expenses under MNREGA.

b. Started Jobs opportunity for Forest Villagers under NREGA:-

The forest village's labours got jobs under NREGA from 15 Nov. 2009 for the work of road from the boarder of Bajpur Bankati forest village to Jangutada Saiphan. But it was only for 5 days.

c. Protest of Forest Villagers on Jangutara Bridge for NREGA Job Demand:-

Forest Villagers made informed that 14 consecutive days work provided by NREGA at once. This information has been provided by DEHAT Team. So the NREGA labours from the forest villages organized a procession for job demand at Jangutara Bridge. Against this activity labours had got 14 consecutive days job under NREGA by Gram Panchayat Officer.

d. Interface of Vangram Adhikar Manch members with Block Development Officer

Five members of Van Adhikar Manch i.e. Geeta Prasad, Bhanmati, Shee Ram, Vakil Ahmad & Saroj Gupta met with B.D.O. on 3rd December 2009 with receiving of filed 1B forms and informed the delay in job under NREGA. B.D.O. called to Durrehasan, Gram Panchayat Officer and told hardly him to provide 100 days job to the labours of forest villages without filled forms. Against these activity labours of forest villages got jobs in soil filling in road at Talika Purwa.

e. Protest of MNREGA Labours at Post Office, Girijapuri:-

The forest villagers (labours) of Chehlawa Gram Panchayat had captured Post Office, Girijapuri on the issue of delay in payment of NREGA on 4th Dec. 2009. The protesters were more than 100 in numbers of male & female. In result Post Master of Post Office paid Rs. 60,000.00 immediately.

f. Organize Social Audit Programme & formation of Majdoor Sangh:-

A Social Audit Programme organized in auditorium of Sharda Sahayak Pariyojna College, Girijapuri on dt. 15 Dec. 2009. Dr. Jitendra Chaturvedi, Chief Executive, Dehat was as resource person. A Labour Union formed at the occasion which name put "Mazdoor Haqdari Morcha". Above 700 NREGA Labours were participated in the programme and formed the Morcha for ensuring wages.



D. RIGHT TO PARTICIPATION:-

- a. Observed Independence Day (15th Aug. 2009) ceremony with Bal Sansads, Kishori Mandals & forest villagers at N.F.E., Centres and Forest Villages
- b. Organized programmes on the occasion of Children's Day on 14th Nov. 2009.
- c. Theatre programmes & Child Personality Development Programmes organized from 19 Nov. to 21 Nov. 2009.
- d. Observed Republic Day (26th Jan.2010) ceremony at every Forest Villages.

Case Study-1

MY ADOLESCENT DAUGHTER SAVED FROM RAPIST

My name is Khargi resident of forest village Kailash Nagar, working as a labour in Central Strate Farm, Girijapuri. I am living in a hut with my two daughters and one son in State Farm, Girijapuri. I am very poor and my wife was died. So, my daughters were living alone in house after departure of mine on duty at Pump No. 14. A contractor of fruits of State Farm Mr. Hanif & their two sons Mr. Mujib & Mr. Atib were regularly come to State Farm near my house. At one day in absence of mine Mr. Atib was started beating my daughter Ms. Suman Kumari and forcing to come with him in Bharbhanda. Suman understood his motive and refused to go with him in Bharbhanda. Then Mr. Atib had shot my daughter by his Air-gun. Now Suman was started crying as she felt pain. When my neighbour Mr. Heeralal heard the shout of Suman, he immediately reached at incidence site and saw to the bounded Suman. He quickly informed to me that my daughter is shot by Atib. Then I get her to Farm main gate. I am also attached with Vangram Adhikar Manch formed by DEHAT organization at Girijapuri. I immediately informed Dehat organization. The volunteers of came with ambulance and take her to local Hospital and then after watching her severity the doctors referred her to Bahraich District Hospital. Then Dehat under the project of Child Rights of CRY-NEW DELHI taken against child protection rights for Suman and lodged FIR at local Police Station Giurijapuri against Mr. Aatib for sexual assault & attempt to murder to minor. Now Suman has recovered and Aatib is in Jail.

RIGHT TO INFORMATION-RTI

‘Dehat’ promotes Right To Information Act as an effective tool to empower the deprived sections for their struggle towards their rights. ‘Dehat’ is providing RTI support in the following manners:

a. Helpline on RTI

We have established two helplines no. 05252-291184 and 09984557591 to help the victims of corruption. During the year, we have received 1176 calls.

b. Camps on RTI

We organize camps to help the victims of corruption directly. In the camps, we conduct community meetings on the RTI Act and correlate the solutions of existing problems with RTI. After the meetings, the applications are drafted on spot by ‘Dehat’ team.

During the year, 9 such camps were organized with 3778 villagers and 2876 applications were drafted and sent to the relevant Govt. departments. By this process, the justice was ensured to 1234 victims on individual problems and 89 community problems.

c. Model Villages through RTI

‘Dehat’ has selected 5 Gram Panchayats in 5 blocks namely Bhauri(Fakhar Pur Block), Bhawaniapur Ramgarhi (Risla Block), Parsaura (Chittaura), Gauriya (Huzurpur) and Meer Ganj-Shekh Daheer (Tejwapur) to develop models. Among the activities, we have organized 60 camps (12 camps in each Gram Panchayat) during the year and facilitated 60 persons to use RTI act on the issues affecting their lives. A total of 300 applications were sent to the concerned departments.

As a result, 32 landless families got possession on patta-lands, 78 poor families were prevented from the fake payment of electricity bills without any connections, 66 families got compensations against house loss during floods and a lot of deprived families have got benefited from Govt. schemes.

LOK NIDHI

(A NABARD Supported Project aimed to Socio-Economic and Political Empowerment of poorest Sections)

Promotion of Women Self Help Groups (SHG)

'Dehat' promotes Self Help Groups of women from poorest families for their socio-economic and political empowerment.

'Dehat' has formed and linked 191 women SHGs. At present, 4536 poorest families are associated with the SHGs.

The details on SHGs are as under:

No. of SHGs	263
No. of SHGs Saving Linked	206
No. of SHGs Credit Linked	172
Total Savings	Rs. 32.25 Lac.
Total Internal Loaning	Rs. 39.51 Lac.
Total Interest Earned	Rs. 1.65 Lac.
SHGs Attempts towards the entitlement realization	127

Entrepreneurship and Micro Enterprise Development

With the help of SHGs and the banks, 'Dehat' has promoted 790 micro-enterprises.

For this, we have facilitated the poorest families to utilize their savings as well as bank loan in a proper manner. In the regular SHG meetings, we have conducted various sessions on 'Entrepreneurship Development'. The results are encouraging.

VILLAGE DEVELOPMENT PLAN-VDP

(A NABARD Supported initiative to develop a Gram Panchayat in Totality through Participatory Planning and Convergence)

Jagtapur is a Gram Panchayat where the poverty and backwardness can be visualized in an extreme position. It consists 22 hamlets and 13 out of these are flood affected. About 500 beegha (100 Acres) land is affected with water logging. There are no regular sources of income due to lack of house hold industries or any institutional source. More than 80% population is living below poverty line. More than 100 youths are migrated from the village in search of livelihood sources.

To improve the situation, 'Dehat' has prepared a participatory integrated development plan. The Gram Panchayat has approved it and after approval it was shared with the National Bank of Agriculture and Rural Development-NABARD, Lucknow Regional Office. NABARD has also approved it. To implement the plan, a committee was constituted with 16 Govt. departments and local bank (Lucknow Kshetriya Grameen Bank) in the Chairmanship of Project Director-District Rural Development Authority. The committee called 'Jagtapur Gram Vikas Samiti'.

'Dehat' is only a facilitator to achieve the goal to develop this village as a model.

- | | | |
|----|---|--------------------------------|
| a. | Construction of Road under Pradhan Mantri Sadak Yojana: | 11.4 Km. |
| b. | Construction of soil link roads under NREGA | : 4350 Meters. |
| c. | Construction of sanitary sock-pits | : 25 |
| d. | Cross drainage | : 01 |
| e. | Sanitary Toilets | : 73 |
| f. | Constriction of Ponds (25X40 Meters) | : 01 |
| g. | Drainage | : 125 Meters. |
| h. | Construction of Houses for weaker sections | : 26 |
| i. | Formation of Self Help Groups | : 08 |
| j. | Sanction of a Bridge on Saryu River | : 180 Meter (Rs. 3.79 Crores) |

The proposals for other programmes have been sent to the concerned departments. The committee conducts the meeting in each quarter to review the progress.

Case Study-

I EMPOWERED FOR NOT MARRY WITH ELDERLY PERSON

My name is Guddi living at Bichhiya Village of Mihinpurwa Block of District Bahraich. My father's name is Roop Lal and I am of 16 years old girl. I belong from poor SC community. My parents and other relatives arranged my marriage with a 40 years elderly person. After the final negotiation my Tilak function had been organized and preparation of marriage would be started.

One day the members of Vangram Adhikar Manch Mr. Gulam Mohammad, Asik Ali, Balak Ram, Heera Lal, Phooljhara & Sukai were meet me and asked about my marriage that I am agree or not for marriage with 40 year person. They were informed me that the groom have already 8 children and his wife has died. I told that I am not marrying on my willing, it is happening on my parents and relatives desire. The members of Vangram Adhikar Manch was suggested me to not marry with 40 years old person because it is very big exploitation to me for life long.

On the day of marriage when Baratis were arrived to my house, my parents and my relatives were very happy but I was taken a strong decision. Baratis were taken food at randomly I came out and indicated Baratis & groom that they return to their home because I am not agree to marry with elderly person. This sentence rocked as an explosive amongst Barati side and amongst villagers. Baratis had threaten me and force to marry. Bu I was strongly stand on my decision and said I shall not marry with 40 years old persons, who have 8 children so far. Then Baratis were returned in morning without taken me as a bride.

UPPFMPAP

(UP Participatory Forest Management & Poverty Alleviation Project) under U.P. Forest Department & Sponsored by JICA

To save the forests and ensure the livelihood of the community residing in the forests depending on the forests for livelihoods, a project has initiated by DEHAT with the partnership of Japan International Cooperation Agency-JICA and Govt. Of Uttar Pradesh.

We are working in 56 remote Tribal dominated villages of Duddhi, Wyndomganj and Myorepur forest Ranges of Renukoot Forest Division of most Nuxal affected Sonbhadra district of Uttar Pradesh.

Dehat led four Partner NGOs in Sonbhadra District of U.P.State for this project in 56 GPs of 3 Blocks of the District. About 2830 forest villagers are attached with the project in the area. They belong to mostly ST & SC communities. This project is handled by DEHAT as Nodal Support Organization (NSO) from February 2010.

Area demarcation for implementation of the project has been accomplished and now partner NGOs are to be join to move forward the work of the project. Monthly District Coordination Meeting, Community Meetings were held during the year. Our baseline survey for the purpose of scope of work in identified areas were given us a good strong understanding about the issues of livelihood and enterprise development etc. This data was far deferent from the previous datas etc.

Rescue of Trafficked Children

In the night of 29th September-2009, the Chief Executive Dr. Jitendra Chaturvedi of the organization was traveling by train no. 195 (Mailani to Gonda). He saw 8 children of the age group of 8-14 years with one trafficker.

After the doubt, he has started enquiry from the trafficker and the children. There was no satisfactory answer. All the children were proposed to be handed over to another trafficker in Gonda. He informed to media and GRP immediately for the action.

At 11.30 the train reached at Bahraich railway station. Print and electronic media was there. But Police has refused to register the FIR. After the refusal, Dr. Jitendra Chaturvedi talked to the Superintendent GRP of Gorakhpur Zone and after that the FIR can be registered under section 14 (Child labor Act-1986), 4/5, 342,374 and 511 PC .

All the children were sent to their home Village-Majhara, PS-Motipur, District- Bahraich under the protection of Railway Police and DEHAT workers. An open meeting was also organized in the village with the parents. Now all are studying in the local Primary School.

